



India's electronics production only 3.3 per cent of global market

India's electronics production is estimated at ₹ 4.58 trillion in 2018-19, which, despite accelerated growth in recent years, still represents only 3.3 per cent share of the global market, which was around ₹ 136 trillion, the Parliament was informed.

The domestic electronics hardware manufacturing sector faces a lack of level-playing field against competing nations on account of several disabili-

ties that render the sector uncompetitive, Minister for Electronics and IT Ravi Shankar Prasad said in a written reply in Rajya Sabha.

According to *PTI*, in response to a question about whether the government is satisfied with the current level of contribution of the Indian electronics industry to the global market, the minister replied in the negative.

The minister pointed out lack of adequate infrastructure, domestic supply chain and logistics, high cost of finance, inadequate availability of quality power, inadequate components manufacturing base, limited design capabilities and focus on research and development by the industry, and inadequacies in skill development as the issues faced by the sector.

Less than half of India's cellphone makers are active

Of the 127 units that manufacture cellphones (89 of these do so exclusively) in India, around 41 per cent are operational—the figure is 55 per cent for the 65 units making battery packs (21 exclusively) and 58 per cent for the 130 making chargers (85 exclusively), according to *Financial Express*.

According to National Policy on Electronics 2019 (NPE 2019), production of mobile handsets rose from sixty million in 2014-15 to 225 million in 2017-18. These units provided employment to more than 600,000 people directly and indirectly.

Fairly low levels of value addition, however, have meant that while

imports of complete phones have fallen from US\$ 8 billion in 2015 to US\$ 3.5 billion in 2018, imports of mobile-specific components rose from US\$ 2.8 billion to US\$ 11.6 billion. Imports of components seem to have fallen in 2019, but that is due to changes in import classification of some items.

NITI Aayog proposes that only EVs be sold in India by 2030

Government think-tank NITI Aayog has put forth a proposal that only electric vehicles (EVs) should be sold in India by 2030. The think-tank believes that setting this target will expand the scope of clean fuel technology beyond two- and three-wheelers in the country.

According to NITI Aayog, as transport remains the sector that burns the most oil, transitioning to hundred per cent EV usage by 2030 will slash India's import dependence considerably.

As per a report in *The Times of India*, NITI Aayog has forwarded a Cabinet note, seeking to assign different responsibilities to different ministries. The road transport and highways ministry will need to prepare a framework to phase out the sale of diesel and petrol vehicles by 2030.

The ministry has also been asked to pilot an e-highways programme—with an overhead electricity network—to enable trucks and buses to operate as EVs on select national highways.

ON THE move

Coolpad appoints Fisher Yuan as India CEO

Coolpad, an Indian smartphone brand established by Coolpad Technologies India Pvt Ltd, has appointed Fisher Yuan as its new India chief executive officer (CEO). As CEO, Fisher will drive the mission and vision of the company while overseeing its day-to-day operations. As Coolpad further strengthens its presence in India, Fisher will create a strategic roadmap for optimum market penetration on the back of the brand's consumer-centric R&D practices.